Coimisiún na Scrúduithe Stáit
State Examinations Commission

Corr na Madadh, Baile Átha Luain, Co. na hIarmhí
Cornamaddy, Athlone, Co. Westmeath.

To: Management Authorities of Second-level Schools **S09/24**

Leaving Certificate History
Prescribed Topics for Documents-based Assessment
in Leaving Certificate examinations 2026 and 2027

1. Assessment arrangements for Leaving Certificate History are outlined in the revised *Leaving Certificate History Syllabus* and the accompanying *Guidelines for Teachers*. There are two components at both Ordinary Level and Higher Level:

   - A report on the research study, with a mark allocation of 20%
   - A terminal examination, with a mark allocation of 80%.

2. The syllabus offers a choice of two Fields of Study:

   - Early Modern
     (Ireland, 1494-1815 and Europe and the wider world, 1492-1815)
   - Later Modern
     (Ireland, 1815-1993 and Europe and the wider world, 1815-1992).

3. At both Higher Level and Ordinary Level the terminal written examination includes questions on each of the twelve topics in the chosen Field of Study: Early Modern or Later Modern. Candidates should answer on three of the topics in their chosen Field of Study as well as answering the compulsory documents-based question on a topic nominated by the State Examinations Commission.

4. **The State Examinations Commission prescribes the following topics for documents-based assessment for examination in the years 2026 and 2027 :**

Later Modern Field of Study
Ireland
Topic 2: Movements for political and social reform, 1870-1914

OR

Early Modern Field of Study
Ireland
Topic 1: Reform and Reformation in Tudor Ireland, 1494-1558

5. Guidelines for undertaking documents-based study may be found in the *Guidelines for Teachers*.

6. Please bring this circular to the attention of all teachers of Leaving Certificate History in your school.

7. Please provide a copy of this circular to the appropriate representative of parents and teachers, for transmission to individual parents and teachers.

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